

Daily Bible Note

Date: 2026-08-12

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: Ezekiel 39:1-10

1 "And you, son of man, prophesy against Gog, and say, 'Thus says the Lord God: "Behold, I am against you, O Gog, the prince of Rosh, Meshech, and Tubal;

2 and I will turn you around and lead you on, bringing you up from the far north, and bring you against the mountains of Israel.

3 Then I will knock the bow out of your left hand, and cause the arrows to fall out of your right hand.

4 You shall fall upon the mountains of Israel, you and all your troops and the peoples who are with you; I will give you to birds of prey of every sort and to the beasts of the field to be devoured.

5 You shall fall on the open field; for I have spoken," says the Lord God.

6 "And I will send fire on Magog and on those who live in security in the coastlands. Then they shall know that I am the Lord.

7 So I will make My holy name known in the midst of My people Israel, and I will not let them profane My holy name anymore. Then the nations shall know that I am the Lord, the Holy One in Israel.

8 Surely it is coming, and it shall be done," says the Lord God. "This is the day of which I have spoken.

9 "Then those who dwell in the cities of Israel will go out and set on fire and burn the weapons, both the shields and bucklers, the bows and arrows, the javelins and spears; and they will make fires with them for seven years.

10 They will not take wood from the field nor cut down any from the forests, because they will make fires with the weapons; and they will plunder those who plundered them, and pillage those who pillaged them," says the Lord God.

II. Key Summary

- God declares to Gog, "I am against you," and says He will turn him around, lead him up from the far north, and bring him against the mountains of Israel (vv. 1–2).
 - God says He will knock the bow from Gog's left hand and the arrows from his right, so that Gog, his troops, and the peoples with him fall on the mountains of Israel and are given to birds of prey and beasts of the field; He will also send fire on Magog and on those living securely in the coastlands (vv. 3–6).
 - God says He will make His holy name known among Israel and will no longer let it be profaned; those living in Israel's cities will go out and burn the enemy's weapons as fuel for seven years, and will plunder those who plundered them (vv. 7–10).
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III. Passage Analysis

The Fiercest Enemy Is the One Being Led

There are four actions here: God turns him around, leads him on, brings him up, and brings him to the mountains. Coming from the far north to the mountains of Israel, Gog appears to be entirely in a passive position. [1]

Gog marches out with a huge army, looking unstoppable, yet the passage uses four verbs to show that God is moving every one of his steps. The side that looks most threatening has been in God's hands the whole time.

God Does All of This So People Truly Know Him

The Gog debacle will demonstrate once and for all the holiness of Yahweh, not as a theological abstraction but in action, as he stands to defend his people against the universal conspiracy of evil. [2]

God keeps saying "then they shall know that I am the Lord" because He cares how people come to know Him. He shows who He is through what He actually does.

IV. Reflection Question

Do you think you actually know God, or do you just know a lot of things about Him?

In this passage God says again and again, "then they shall know that I am the Lord" — everything He does is meant to make Him truly known.

References

[1] Chinese Christian Bible Study Site, Yau-Chi Tong, Tien Dao Bible Commentary: Ezekiel, <https://www.ccbiblestudy.org/Old%20Testament/26Ezek/26GT39.htm>

[2] Enduring Word (David Guzik), quoting Daniel Block, <https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/ezekiel-39/>